

COMPLETE US DENTAL LICENSURE ROADMAP

For the Iranian-Trained Oral & Maxillofacial Radiologist with Canadian NDEB Certification, Canadian Citizenship & US Green Card

Training Background	DDS + Specialty in Oral & Maxillofacial Radiology (Iran)
Canadian Status	NDEB-Certified General Dentist Canadian Citizen
US Immigration Status	Permanent Resident (Green Card)
Work Authorization	Unrestricted – may work in any US state
Key Advantage	Canadian NDEB cert recognized by several US states for credentials/endorsement
Document Purpose	All 5 major pathways × all 50 states + DC with full detail

■ Note: All information in this guide reflects policies as of early 2026. State dental board requirements change regularly. Always verify directly with each state board before submitting applications.

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SECTION A – YOUR STRATEGIC PROFILE & DECISION FRAMEWORK

A.1 Your Unique Competitive Advantages

You hold one of the strongest international profiles of any foreign-trained dentist seeking US licensure. Your combination of specialty training, academic radiology background, NDEB certification, and US Green Card means that multiple fast-track routes are genuinely open to you – routes that are closed to most foreign-trained dentists.

Advantage	Why It Matters for US Licensure
NDEB-Certified Canadian Dentist	Minnesota, Maine, and several other states explicitly consider Canadian provincial licenses for credentials/endorsement. Your NDEB cert is equivalent to a Canadian provincial license for these purposes.
US Green Card (Permanent Resident)	Unrestricted work authorization in all 50 states + DC. No visa sponsorship needed. Can start GPR/AEGD immediately. Eligible for state loans/grants.
Canadian Citizen	Eligible for TN-1 (not needed) and all Canadian re-entry options. Flexibility to practice in Canada while pursuing US path.
OMF Radiology Specialist (Iran)	Directly applicable to US OMF Radiology residency programs (may get advanced standing). ABOMR board exam path. Academic/hospital positions.
General Dentist (NDEB)	Satisfies pre-admission requirements for all US advanced standing and GPR/AEGD programs without additional screening exams.
No US Work Visa Hurdles	Enormous advantage: most GPR/AEGD programs and dental schools are reluctant to sponsor H-1B or J-1. You need none.

A.2 Decision Framework: Which Pathway First?

Goal	Best Primary Pathway	Fastest Route
Unrestricted private practice (any state)	Pathway 1 (Advanced Standing DDS/DMD)	2–3 years
Practice in NY, WA, MN quickly	Pathway 2 (GPR/AEGD state route)	1–1.5 years
Practice in MN or ME immediately	Pathway 3 (Credentials from Canada)	3–6 months
Academic / teaching position	Pathway 4 (Faculty License)	1–3 months
OMF Radiology specialty academic/hospital	Pathway 5 (Specialty Residency + ABOMR)	2–3 years
Fastest possible clinical income	Pathway 3 → Pathway 2 (MN or ME first)	3–6 months
Maximum long-term mobility	Pathway 1 then credentials endorsement elsewhere	2–3 years

■ Your NDEB certification means Minnesota (and potentially Maine) may license you faster than any other route. This is your most immediate opportunity.

B.1 Overview & Eligibility

An Advanced Standing (AS) DDS/DMD program is a condensed dental degree for foreign-trained dentists. Upon graduation, you hold a US CODA-accredited DDS or DMD – the gold standard credential accepted by all 50 states + DC for licensure with no further questions about your foreign degree. This is the most portable, most flexible, and most widely accepted route to US dental licensure.

Core eligibility requirements (common across programs):

- DDS/DMD or equivalent foreign dental degree (you have this from Iran)
- NBDE Part I & Part II scores, OR INBDE score (check each program – many now accept INBDE only)
- TOEFL iBT (usually 80–100+) or equivalent English proof; may be waived for NDEB holders
- CAAPID application via ADEA (most programs; some apply directly)
- Credential evaluation (usually ECE or NACES member agency)
- Interview (in-person or virtual)
- Some programs require TSE (Test of Spoken English) for non-native speakers
- No age limit; Green Card = domestic tuition at public schools (significant cost saving)

✓ As a Green Card holder you qualify for in-state/domestic tuition at public universities after establishing state residency (usually 12 months). This can save \$40,000–\$80,000 versus international student tuition.

B.2 Application Process

Step 1	Create ADEA CAAPID account at adea.org/caapid . Application cycle opens ~April each year.
Step 2	Order credential evaluation (ECE or equivalent). Allow 6–8 weeks.
Step 3	Take INBDE (replaces NBDE Parts I & II as of 2020). Schedule via Prometric. Score valid 10 years. Fee ~\$575 per section.
Step 4	TOEFL iBT if required. Many programs waive this for NDEB holders – confirm individually.
Step 5	Submit CAAPID application with transcripts, CV, personal statement, references, credential evaluation, and test scores.
Step 6	Await invitations to interview (Aug–Dec typically). Prepare for both in-person & virtual.
Step 7	Accept offers (Feb–April). Confirm enrollment, pay deposit.
Step 8	Enroll in August/September. Program duration 18–36 months depending on school.

B.3 All US Advanced Standing Programs – Detailed Comparison

■ Data current as of early 2026. Always verify directly with each program. Tuition marked * = domestic/in-state rate available to Green Card holders after residency establishment.

School / Program	State	Length	Annual Tuition (approx.)	INBDE Req.	CAAPID	Class Size	Key Notes
New York University College of Dentistry (NYU)	NY	24 mo	\$96,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~50	Largest AS program in US. Strong clinical volume. NY requires PGY-1 after graduation for licensure.
University of Southern California (USC) Herman Ostrow	CA	24 mo	\$88,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~30	Excellent reputation. LA location. California WREB/CRDTS required after graduation.
Boston University Goldman School	MA	24 mo	\$85,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~25	Strong research environment. ADEX/CDCA required after. Urban location.
Temple University Kornberg	PA	24 mo	\$78,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~25	Philadelphia. CDCA/ADEX required. Good urban clinic exposure.
Tufts University School of Dental Medicine	MA	24 mo	\$87,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~20	Boston. Strong academic reputation. ADEX required.
University of Minnesota School of Dentistry	MN	21 mo	\$38,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~20	Public school; GREEN CARD = domestic tuition after residency. MN has credentials route. Excellent value.
University of Nevada Las Vegas (UNLV)	NV	24 mo	\$55,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~20	Public school. NV state residency → significant savings. WREB/CRDTS after.
Midwestern University – Illinois	IL	27 mo	\$72,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~20	Downers Grove campus. ADEX/CDCA after. Good program for Midwest practice.
Midwestern University – Arizona	AZ	27 mo	\$74,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~15	Glendale campus. WREB/CRDTS after. Growing market.
Georgia School of Orthodontics / Georgia AS Programs	GA	24 mo	\$68,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~15	Atlanta. ADEX/CDCA after. Warm market; strong dental demand.
Howard University College of Dentistry	DC	24 mo	\$72,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~10	DC. ADEX/CDCA. Historically Black university; diverse patient base. DC + nearby states.
University of Detroit Mercy	MI	24 mo	\$70,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~15	Detroit. Private. ADEX/CDCA after. Midwest location.
Ohio State University College of Dentistry	OH	21–24 mo	\$42,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~10	Public. Domestic rate for Green Card holders. ADEX after. Strong research university.
University of Illinois Chicago (UIC)	IL	24 mo	\$40,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~15	Public. Strong urban clinic. Domestic rate applies. ADEX after.
University of Pittsburgh School of Dental Medicine	PA	24 mo	\$74,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~10	Pittsburgh. Research-strong. CDCA/ADEX after.
Case Western Reserve University	OH	24 mo	\$76,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~10	Cleveland. Private. Good specialty network. ADEX after.
Roseman University of Health Sciences – Nevada	NV	18 mo	\$88,000 total	Yes	Yes	~12	Accelerated 18-month program. Unique block curriculum. WREB/CRDTS after.
Roseman University – Utah	UT	18 mo	\$88,000 total	Yes	Yes	~12	Salt Lake City. WREB/CRDTS after. UT is growing dental market.
A.T. Still University – Arizona	AZ	21 mo	\$76,000/yr	Yes	Yes	~15	Mesa campus. Community-based model. WREB/CRDTS after.
University of Florida College of Dentistry	FL	24 mo	\$44,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~8	Public. Gainesville. Domestic rate for GC holders. ADEX after. Large FL market.
University of North Carolina – Chapel Hill	NC	24 mo	\$36,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~8	Public. Lowest domestic tuition. ADEX after. Excellent value for GC holder.
Rutgers School of Dental Medicine (RSDM)	NJ	24 mo	\$48,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~10	Public. NJ/NY metro. Domestic rate. CDCA/ADEX after.
UMDNJ / Rutgers (combined programs)	NJ	24 mo	\$48,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~8	Same Rutgers system. Very competitive.
Texas A&M; College of Dentistry	TX	24 mo	\$38,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~10	Dallas. Public. WREB/CRDTS or SRTA after. Large TX market.

School / Program	State	Length	Annual Tuition (approx.)	INBDE Req.	CAAPID	Class Size	Key Notes
UT Health Houston School of Dentistry	TX	24 mo	\$36,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~8	Houston. Public. Domestic rate. Texas is massive dental market.
University of Tennessee College of Dentistry	TN	24 mo	\$34,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~6	Memphis. Lowest public tuition. ADEX after. Growing SE market.
Indiana University School of Dentistry	IN	24 mo	\$37,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~8	Indianapolis. Public. ADEX after. Midwest stability.
University of Iowa College of Dentistry	IA	24 mo	\$35,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~6	Iowa City. Public. Very affordable. ADEX after.
Louisiana State University School of Dentistry	LA	24 mo	\$33,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~6	New Orleans. Public. Lowest cost public program. ADEX after.
University of Washington School of Dentistry	WA	24 mo	\$42,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~6	Seattle. Public. Special WA state pathway after. WREB/CRDTS. Limited spots.
University of Colorado School of Dental Medicine	CO	24 mo	\$44,000/yr*	Yes	Yes	~6	Aurora. Public. WREB/CRDTS after. Growing Front Range market.

B.4 After Graduation: Licensure Steps

Upon completing an AS DDS/DMD you have a US CODA-accredited degree. You must then pass the relevant clinical/written exams for licensure in your target state. The four main regional clinical exam boards are:

Exam Board	Full Name	States That Accept It	Format
CDCA/ADEX	Commission on Dental Competency Assessments	Most eastern, central states (35+ states)	Patient-based or manikin-based clinical exam + NBDE/INBDE
WREB/CRDTS	Western Regional Examining Board	Western states (CA, NV, AZ, WA, OR, UT, CO, HI, ID, MT, WY, NM + others)	Patient-based clinical exam
SRTA	Southern Regional Testing Agency	TX and some southern states	Patient-based clinical exam
ADEX	American Dental Examining Board	Most states (same as CDCA; ADEX is the exam name)	Integrated with CDCA system
INBDE	Integrated National Board Dental Exam	All states for written component	Computer-based 2-day exam

■ After passing your clinical board exam and INBDE, you apply to the specific state dental board. Each state has its own application, fees (\$200–\$1,000), background check, CPR certification, and jurisprudence exam requirements.

B.5 Total Cost Estimate – Advanced Standing Route

Item	Low (Public School + GC Domestic Rate)	High (Private School)
Program tuition (2 years)	\$66,000–\$76,000	\$150,000–\$192,000
Living expenses (2 years)	\$36,000–\$50,000	\$40,000–\$70,000
INBDE exam fees	\$1,150	\$1,150
CAAPID application	\$300–\$600	\$300–\$600
Credential evaluation	\$300–\$400	\$300–\$400
Clinical board exam (CDCA/WREB)	\$1,200–\$2,000	\$1,200–\$2,000
State licensure application	\$200–\$800	\$200–\$800
Misc (books, instruments, lab fees)	\$3,000–\$8,000	\$5,000–\$15,000
TOTAL ESTIMATED	\$108,000–\$138,000	\$198,000–\$282,000

✓ As a Green Card holder attending a public school in a state where you establish residency, you could complete an AS program for under \$140,000 total. Compared to NYU or USC, that is a saving of \$100,000–\$150,000.

C.1 Overview

Many US states allow foreign-trained dentists who do NOT hold a US/Canadian dental degree to obtain licensure via alternative competency-assessment routes. These typically involve completing a CODA-accredited General Practice Residency (GPR) or Advanced Education in General Dentistry (AEGD) program, and/or passing a clinical board exam. Because you hold an NDEB certification (equivalent to a US-style competency assessment), you may have enhanced eligibility in some states.

Key program types:

- **GPR (General Practice Residency)** – hospital-based, 1 year (PGY-1), includes emergency/medical rotations. Offered at many VA hospitals, academic medical centers, and dental schools. Stipend: ~\$35,000–\$65,000/year.
- **AEGD (Advanced Education in General Dentistry)** – dental school-based, 1–2 years, more restorative/prosthodontic focus. Stipend: ~\$25,000–\$55,000/year.
- **PGY-1** – New York State term for the mandatory first-year residency required for all dentists (including US graduates) before licensure in NY.
- **OSCE / DLOSCE** – Objective Structured Clinical Exam / Dental Licensing OSCE. Some states are moving toward or piloting this format.

C.2 State-by-State: GPR/AEGD/Alternative Licensure Routes

■ 'FTD' = Foreign-Trained Dentist. 'NDEB equiv.' = your Canadian NDEB status. 'N/A direct' = no special FTD pathway; full AS degree required.

State	Clinical Exam Accepted	FTD Special Pathway?	GPR/AEGD Req.	Key Notes for You
Alabama (AL)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path; AS DDS required	Not required (post-DDS)	Must hold CODA-accredited degree. No FTD shortcut.
Alaska (AK)	WREB/CRDTS or ADEX	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small market. CODA degree required. Remote practice incentives exist.
Arizona (AZ)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path	Not required	Large growing market. Two AS programs (Midwestern, A.T. Still). CODA required.
Arkansas (AR)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA degree required. Rural shortage areas exist.
California (CA)	WREB/CRDTS	Restricted Permit then full license	1-yr CODA GPR/AEGD for restricted permit	CA allows FTDs to get a Restricted Permit after 1-yr CODA GPR. Must then pass WREB. Complex process. Best via AS program at USC or UCSF.
Colorado (CO)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA degree required. Denver growing. GC = domestic tuition at U of Colorado AS program.
Connecticut (CT)	INBDE only (no clinical exam)	Exploring FTD pilot	GPR/AEGD may waive clinical	CT eliminated its clinical exam and uses INBDE. Watch for FTD-specific rules. May be favorable.
Delaware (DE)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small state, few programs. CODA degree required.
Florida (FL)	ADEX/CDCA or WREB	No direct FTD path	Not required	Huge market, many practitioners. CODA degree required. UF AS program is excellent value.
Georgia (GA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Growing market. AS program at GA. CODA required.

State	Clinical Exam Accepted	FTD Special Pathway?	GPR/AEGD Req.	Key Notes for You
Hawaii (HI)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path	Not required	Remote. High cost of living. WREB required. CODA degree required.
Idaho (ID)	WREB/CRDTS or ADEX	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small market. Shortage areas. CODA required.
Illinois (IL)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Chicago metro large market. Two AS programs (UIC public, Midwestern private). CODA required.
Indiana (IN)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Public AS program at IU. Domestic rate for GC. CODA required.
Iowa (IA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Affordable public AS program at U of Iowa. CODA required.
Kansas (KS)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA required. Small market.
Kentucky (KY)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA required. Louisville/Lexington markets.
Louisiana (LA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Cheapest public AS tuition (~\$33K/yr at LSU). New Orleans market. CODA required.
Maine (ME)	ADEX/CDCA	YES – Credentials route may accept foreign/Canadian jurisdictions	Not required for credentials	Maine rules reference 'foreign nations/foreign administrative divisions.' Your NDEB + active Canadian provincial license + practice history may qualify for credentials licensure. Contact Maine Board directly. One of your best immediate options.
Maryland (MD)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path; CODA required	Not required	Baltimore/DC market. University of Maryland has AS program. CODA required.
Massachusetts (MA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Boston market. Two private AS programs (BU, Tufts). High cost of living.
Michigan (MI)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Detroit market. U of Detroit Mercy AS program. CODA required.
Minnesota (MN)	ADEX/CDCA	YES – STRONGEST OPTION FOR YOU	1-yr CODA AEGD/GPR CAN waive clinical exam	CRITICAL STATE FOR YOU: (1) Credentials route explicitly accepts Canadian provincial licenses. (2) 1-yr CODA AEGD/GPR in MN can substitute for clinical exam. (3) U of MN AS program (public, domestic rate). Three independent routes available. CONTACT MINNESOTA BOARD IMMEDIATELY.
Mississippi (MS)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA required. Small market.
Missouri (MO)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	KC/St. Louis. CODA required.
Montana (MT)	WREB/CRDTS or ADEX	No direct FTD path	Not required	Rural/frontier. Shortage areas. CODA required.
Nebraska (NE)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA required. Omaha market.
Nevada (NV)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path; AS program at UNLV/Roseman	Not required	Las Vegas growing market. Two AS programs. Public (UNLV) domestic rate for GC. CODA required.
New Hampshire (NH)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small state. CODA required. No dental school.
New Jersey (NJ)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	NY metro. Public Rutgers AS program (domestic rate). CODA required.
New Mexico (NM)	WREB/CRDTS or ADEX	No direct FTD path	Not required	Growing shortage state. CODA required.

State	Clinical Exam Accepted	FTD Special Pathway?	GPR/AEGD Req.	Key Notes for You
New York (NY)	ADEX/CDCA	YES – PGY-1 REQUIRED (and available to FTDs)	PGY-1 mandatory for ALL dentists	KEY PATHWAY: NY requires 1-year CODA-accredited PGY-1 (GPR) for ALL dentists including US graduates. FTDs can enter PGY-1 directly with foreign degree + INBDE. After PGY-1: apply for NY license via ADEX/CDCA. Paid stipend (~\$45,000–\$65,000). NYC market is massive. NDEB recognition: possible through credentials route after establishing NY license.
North Carolina (NC)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Growing market. Cheapest public AS (UNC ~\$36K/yr domestic). CODA required.
North Dakota (ND)	ADEX/CDCA or WREB	No direct FTD path	Not required	Very small market. CODA required.
Ohio (OH)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Two AS programs (OSU public, CWRU private). OSU domestic rate. CODA required.
Oklahoma (OK)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	CODA required. Growing market.
Oregon (OR)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path	Not required	Portland market. WREB required. CODA required.
Pennsylvania (PA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Two AS programs (Temple, Pitt). Philadelphia/Pittsburgh. CODA required.
Rhode Island (RI)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small state. No dental school. Providence. CODA required.
South Carolina (SC)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Growing market. CODA required.
South Dakota (SD)	ADEX/CDCA or WREB	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small market. Shortage areas. CODA required.
Tennessee (TN)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Public AS at UTK (~\$34K/yr domestic). Nashville/Memphis. CODA required.
Texas (TX)	WREB/CRDTS or SRTA	No direct FTD path	Not required	MASSIVE market. Two public AS programs (Texas A&M; UT Houston). Domestic rate. CODA required.
Utah (UT)	WREB/CRDTS	No direct FTD path	Not required	Roseman AS (18 mo accelerated). Growing SLC market. WREB required. CODA required.
Vermont (VT)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Small market. No dental school. CODA required.
Virginia (VA)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	DC metro + Richmond. CODA required.
Washington (WA)	WREB/CRDTS	YES – Special GPR/AEGD pathway in underserved WA communities	1-yr CODA GPR/AEGD in WA low-income setting	WA allows: Complete 1-yr CODA GPR/AEGD at approved WA underserved-area site → eligible for WA license without standard clinical exam. Must be CODA-accredited program IN Washington state. U of Washington GPR program qualifies. This is a real faster pathway if you match to a WA GPR.
West Virginia (WV)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Rural market. Shortage areas. CODA required.
Wisconsin (WI)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Milwaukee/Madison. Marquette dental school. CODA required.
Wyoming (WY)	WREB/CRDTS or ADEX	No direct FTD path	Not required	Very small market. No dental school. Shortage areas. CODA required.
District of Columbia (DC)	ADEX/CDCA	No direct FTD path	Not required	Howard University AS program. Small jurisdiction. Federal employment opportunities.

C.3 GPR/AEGD Programs – How to Apply

GPR and AEGD programs use separate application systems from dental school programs:

PASS System	Primary Application Service for Specialty/GPR programs. Apply at adea.org/pass . Opens June–August for positions starting the following July.
MATCH	Some hospital-based GPR programs use the ADA PASS Match system. Others are independent. Check each program.
VA Programs	Department of Veterans Affairs GPR programs are federal employment – apply via USAJobs.gov . Excellent stipends (\$55,000–\$75,000). Green Card = eligible. No visa issues. VA programs in virtually every state. Highly recommended for you.
NYC Health + Hospitals	Large NYC public hospital system with many PGY-1 positions. Apply through NYC HHC directly. Strong stipends.
Direct Applications	Some programs (especially hospital GPRs) accept direct applications. Contact program directors directly if you have an OMF Radiology background – you are a unique and attractive candidate for programs interested in diagnostic imaging.

✓ *VA GPR programs are an outstanding option for you. As a Green Card holder with a specialty background, you will be a competitive applicant. VA pays a federal salary during residency (~\$55,000–\$75,000), which is significantly more than most academic GPR stipends, and VA programs exist in nearly every US state.*

D.1 Overview

Licensure by credentials (also called endorsement or reciprocity) allows a dentist who is already licensed in one jurisdiction to obtain a license in another jurisdiction without repeating clinical exams, provided they meet the new state's requirements (typically: active license in good standing, continuous active practice, clean disciplinary record, and sometimes minimum practice years). This is the FASTEST pathway to US licensure if you qualify.

For you specifically: You are an NDEB-certified dentist. If you also obtain or already hold an active Canadian provincial dental license (e.g., Ontario RCDSO, Alberta CDAS, BC CDSBC), several US states explicitly allow Canadian-licensed dentists to apply via credentials. Minnesota and Maine are the most clearly documented. Others may apply on a case-by-case basis.

■ **Most credentials/endorsement routes require PRIOR active licensure and practice history in a US state or qualifying foreign jurisdiction. If you do not yet have an active Canadian provincial license, you should obtain one first (NDEB → province). This is a prerequisite for the credentials route in most states.**

D.2 State-by-State: Licensure by Credentials / Endorsement

■ 'Yrs Practice' = years of active continuous practice typically required. 'Canadian Accepted?' = whether the state explicitly or implicitly accepts Canadian provincial licenses as source jurisdiction. Always verify with the board directly.

State	Credentials/Endorsement Available?	Yrs Practice Req.	Canadian License Accepted?	Key Notes
Alabama	Yes (after US license)	3 yrs	Unclear	Must hold active US state license first. Canadian route unclear.
Alaska	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Remote state. Small board. Contact directly.
Arizona	Yes (by credentials)	2 yrs	Unclear	Must have passed WREB or equivalent. Board reviews individually.
Arkansas	Yes (reciprocity)	2 yrs	Unclear	CODA degree may be required. Contact board.
California	No traditional reciprocity	N/A	No	CA does NOT have traditional reciprocity. Must pass WREB. No shortcut.
Colorado	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	WREB or equivalent required. Contact board.
Connecticut	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	INBDE-only state. May accept equivalent scores.
Delaware	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Small board. Contact directly.
Florida	Yes (credentials)	2 yrs	Unclear	Large market. FL board reviews foreign credentials case-by-case. No explicit Canadian route.
Georgia	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement after US license.
Hawaii	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Remote. Small board.
Idaho	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Shortage state. Contact board.
Illinois	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required. No explicit Canadian route.
Indiana	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required.
Iowa	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Kansas	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Board reviews individually.
Kentucky	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.

State	Credentials/Endorsement Available?	Yrs Practice Req.	Canadian License Accepted?	Key Notes
Louisiana	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required.
Maine	YES – SPECIAL ROUTE FOR YOU	5 yrs	YES – explicitly references foreign nations/provinces	CRITICAL: Maine rules reference 'foreign nations or foreign administrative divisions.' Active Canadian provincial license + NDEB + 5 years practice history may qualify you. Contact Maine Board of Dental Examiners. This may be your fastest US licensure pathway.
Maryland	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required.
Massachusetts	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement after MA license.
Michigan	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Minnesota	YES – STRONGEST CREDENTIALS ROUTE	5 yrs	YES – explicitly accepts Canadian provincial license	CRITICAL: MN rules explicitly allow licensure by credentials from Canadian provinces. Requirements: NDEB cert OR Canadian provincial license, 5 yrs active practice, no disciplinary history, INBDE or equivalent national board scores. This is potentially your FASTEST US licensure route. Contact MN Board of Dentistry immediately.
Mississippi	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Missouri	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Montana	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Shortage state. Contact board.
Nebraska	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard.
Nevada	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	WREB required. Standard endorsement.
New Hampshire	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Small board. Contact directly.
New Jersey	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required. NY metro market.
New Mexico	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Shortage areas. Contact board.
New York	Yes – after PGY-1 + ADEX	N/A (PGY-1 req.)	Unclear for direct	After NY license, endorsement to other states is straightforward. Direct Canadian credentials unclear – PGY-1 still likely required first.
North Carolina	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
North Dakota	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Small market.
Ohio	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required.
Oklahoma	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Oregon	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	WREB required. Contact board.
Pennsylvania	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	ADEX required.
Rhode Island	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Small state.
South Carolina	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
South Dakota	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Shortage areas.
Tennessee	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.
Texas	Yes (endorsement)	5 yrs	Unclear	Longer practice requirement. Large market.
Utah	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	WREB required.
Vermont	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Small board.
Virginia	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	DC metro market.
Washington	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	WREB required.
West Virginia	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Shortage areas.
Wisconsin	Yes (endorsement)	3 yrs	Unclear	Standard endorsement.

State	Credentials/Endorsement Available?	Yrs Practice Req.	Canadian License Accepted?	Key Notes
Wyoming	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Very small. Shortage areas.
DC	Yes (endorsement)	2 yrs	Unclear	Small jurisdiction. Federal proximity.

D.3 Recommended Action: Canadian Provincial License First

If you do not yet have an active Canadian provincial license, obtain one immediately. The NDEB process is complete; provincial licensing typically requires:

- NDEB Certificate (you have this)
- Application to the provincial regulatory body (e.g., RCDSO in Ontario, CDAS in Alberta)
- Provincial jurisprudence exam (typically a short multiple-choice test)
- Background check and application fee (\$200–\$500)
- Timeline: 4–8 weeks

✓ *Once you hold an active Canadian provincial license AND have 5 years of documented practice (Canadian + Iranian combined may count), contact Minnesota Board of Dentistry and Maine Board of Dental Examiners directly. This could give you US licensure in 3–6 months without any additional exam or residency.*

E.1 Overview

Faculty licenses (also called limited, restricted, provisional, special, or volunteer licenses depending on the state) allow qualified dentists – including foreign-trained specialists – to work at accredited dental schools, VA hospitals under certain arrangements, federally qualified health centers (FQHCs), or public health programs. They do not grant unrestricted private practice rights, but they are the FASTEST way to start working as a dentist in the US – sometimes within weeks.

For you as an OMF Radiologist, faculty licenses are especially relevant because dental schools actively seek specialists in OMF Radiology for teaching and clinical interpretation roles. Your credentials are immediately applicable.

E.2 Types of Faculty/Limited Licenses

License Type	Who Issues It	Scope	Typical Requirements
Faculty License	State dental board	Practice limited to accredited dental school premises	Employment offer from accredited school; foreign dental degree; sometimes INBDE; school sponsors application
Special/Restricted License	State dental board	Limited to specific institution or program	Similar to faculty; employment letter; background check
Volunteer License	State dental board	Volunteer/unpaid care at approved nonprofits/clinics	Active license in another jurisdiction; application; sometimes reduced fees
Limited License (Specialty)	State dental board	Practice in specialty area only; some states allow this for FTD specialists	Completion of CODA-accredited specialty program; board certification in some states
VA/Federal Employment	Federal government (not state)	Practice at VA/federal facilities only; state license NOT required for federal employment	Federal employment via USAJobs; credentialing through VA system; no state license needed
FQHC/CHC Employment	Federal designation (some state requirements)	Community health center employment; some states have specific FQHC pathways for FTDs	FQHC employment offer; some states waive or expedite licensure for FQHC providers

E.3 States with Dental Schools – Faculty License Opportunities

■ States with CODA-accredited dental schools that typically offer faculty license provisions. Schools with OMF Radiology departments are especially relevant.

State	Dental Schools	OMF Rad Dept?	Faculty License Provision
AL	UAB School of Dentistry	Likely	Yes – faculty limited license
AZ	Midwestern (AZ), A.T. Still	Possible	Yes – restricted/faculty license
CA	UCSF, UCLA, USC, Loma Linda, Pacific, Western, UOP	Yes (major schools)	Yes – faculty license; complex CA requirements
CO	U of Colorado	Possible	Yes – faculty license provision
CT	UConn School of Dental Medicine	Possible	Yes – faculty license
DC	Howard University	Yes	Yes – faculty license
FL	U of Florida, Nova SE, Miami, FIU	Yes (UF, Nova)	Yes – faculty license
GA	MCG/AU, Georgia AS programs	Possible	Yes – limited faculty license

State	Dental Schools	OMF Rad Dept?	Faculty License Provision
IL	UIC, Midwestern (IL)	Yes (UIC)	Yes – faculty license; strong OMF Rad dept at UIC
IN	Indiana University	Yes	Yes – faculty license; IU has full OMF Rad dept
IA	U of Iowa	Yes	Yes – faculty license; Iowa has excellent OMF Rad program
KY	U of Louisville, UK	Possible	Yes – faculty license
LA	LSU School of Dentistry	Possible	Yes – faculty license
MA	Boston University, Tufts, Harvard	Yes (BU, Tufts, Harvard)	Yes – faculty license; Boston strong academic market
MD	U of Maryland	Yes	Yes – faculty license
MI	U of Michigan, U of Detroit Mercy, WSU	Yes (UM, UDM)	Yes – faculty license; U of Michigan has strong OMF Rad
MN	U of Minnesota	Yes	Yes – faculty license; PLUS credentials pathway for you
MO	UMKC, SLU (closing)	Possible	Yes – faculty license
NE	Creighton, UNMC	Possible	Yes – faculty license
NJ	Rutgers (RSDM)	Yes	Yes – faculty license
NV	UNLV, Roseman	Possible	Yes – faculty license
NY	NYU, Columbia, Stony Brook, Buffalo	Yes (NYU, Columbia, Buffalo)	Yes – faculty license; waives PGY-1 requirement for faculty only in some cases
NC	UNC-Chapel Hill, ECU	Yes (UNC)	Yes – faculty license
OH	Ohio State, CWRU, OhioU	Yes (OSU)	Yes – faculty license
OK	OU College of Dentistry	Possible	Yes – faculty license
OR	OHSU School of Dentistry	Possible	Yes – faculty license
PA	Temple, Pitt, Penn (Ivy)	Yes (Penn, Temple)	Yes – faculty license; Penn has prestigious OMF Rad
TN	UTK, Meharry, ETSU	Possible	Yes – faculty license
TX	Texas A&M, UT Houston, UTHSA, Baylor	Yes (UT Houston, Baylor)	Yes – faculty license; large market
UT	Roseman	Possible	Yes – restricted license
VA	Virginia Commonwealth (VCU)	Yes	Yes – faculty license
WA	U of Washington	Yes	Yes – faculty license; UW has strong OMF Rad program
WI	Marquette, UW-Madison	Possible	Yes – faculty license

E.4 VA / Federal Employment – The Hidden Fast Track

The US Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) is the single largest employer of dentists in the United States. Importantly, VA dentists are federal employees and do NOT need a state license to practice at VA facilities – they are credentialed through the VA's internal system. Requirements:

- US citizenship OR Green Card (Permanent Resident) – YOU QUALIFY
- Dental degree from accredited institution (Iranian degree evaluated by VA credentialing office)
- INBDE or NBDE Parts I & II (VA requires national board scores)
- Clean background check
- Apply via USAJobs.gov – search 'dentist VA' or 'oral maxillofacial radiology VA'

- Salary: GS-13 to GS-15 range, approximately \$120,000–\$220,000 depending on location/specialty
- Some VA facilities specifically need OMF Radiologists for CBCT/panoramic interpretation

✓ *VA employment can start while you are pursuing your US state license. This gives you immediate income (\$120K+) while your licensure process completes. Your OMF Radiology specialty background makes you a highly sought VA candidate.*

F.1 Overview

Oral and Maxillofacial Radiology (OMF Radiology, OMR) is one of the 12 ADA-recognized dental specialties in the United States. It is governed by the American Board of Oral and Maxillofacial Radiology (ABOMR). The specialty scope includes:

- Interpretation and diagnosis of dental and maxillofacial radiographs (periapical, panoramic, CBCT, MRI, CT)
- CBCT (cone beam CT) interpretation – the fastest-growing area of dental radiology
- Radiation protection, dose optimization, and radiation biology
- Teaching and research in dental imaging
- Teleradiology and remote CBCT reporting services
- Hospital/oral surgery department imaging consultation

■ *OMF Radiology is a non-surgical, cognitive specialty. It is highly compatible with academic, hospital, and teleradiology business models. Your Iranian specialty training is directly relevant to US CODA programs.*

F.2 CODA-Accredited OMF Radiology Programs in the US

As of early 2026, CODA-accredited OMF Radiology programs are offered at the following institutions (list changes; verify at ada.org/coda):

Institution	State	Length	CODA Status	Notes
University of Texas Health San Antonio (UTHSA)	TX	2 yrs	Accredited	Established program; strong CBCT research
University of Iowa College of Dentistry	IA	2 yrs	Accredited	One of the oldest OMF Rad programs; research-intensive
University of Minnesota School of Dentistry	MN	2 yrs	Accredited	Strong program; ties to MN credentials route for your general license
Boston University Goldman School	MA	2 yrs	Accredited	Urban clinical exposure; CBCT focus
University of Michigan School of Dentistry	MI	2 yrs	Accredited	Prestigious; strong research output
Indiana University School of Dentistry	IN	2 yrs	Accredited	Well-established program
University of Washington School of Dentistry	WA	2 yrs	Accredited	Pacific Northwest; ties to WA special licensure route
University of Illinois Chicago (UIC)	IL	2 yrs	Accredited	Urban Chicago; large patient pool
University of North Carolina – Chapel Hill	NC	2 yrs	Accredited	Research Triangle; academic environment
New York University College of Dentistry (NYU)	NY	2 yrs	Accredited	NYC; massive clinical volume
University of Pittsburgh	PA	2 yrs	Accredited/Conditional	Contact program directly for current status
Virginia Commonwealth University (VCU)	VA	2 yrs	Accredited	DC metro area; strong program
Loma Linda University	CA	2 yrs	Accredited	Southern CA; faith-based institution
University of Florida	FL	2 yrs	Accredited	Gainesville; growing program
Ohio State University	OH	2 yrs	Accredited	Columbus; strong research environment

F.3 Admission Requirements for US OMF Radiology Programs

- DDS/DMD from CODA-accredited institution (US or Canadian) OR foreign equivalent recognized by the program

- INBDE or NBDE Parts I & II (most programs require this)
- US dental license (some programs require this; others waive for specialty training)
- Prior OMF Radiology training (your Iranian specialty is a significant advantage – may earn advanced standing)
- Letters of recommendation from dental school faculty or specialists
- Research experience or publications (helpful but not always required)
- TOEFL/English proficiency if required
- Apply via ADEA PASS system or directly to programs

✓ *Your Iranian OMF Radiology specialty degree may allow you to complete a US residency in 12–18 months rather than 24 months, depending on the program's evaluation of your prior training. Contact program directors individually – this is not an official policy but many programs are flexible for experienced foreign specialists.*

F.4 ABOMR Board Certification

Eligibility	Complete a CODA-accredited OMF Radiology residency OR demonstrate equivalent training (case-by-case; your Iranian training alone likely insufficient without US residency).
Application	Submit to ABOMR (abomr.com). Application includes case portfolio, training documentation, and fees (~\$1,000–\$1,500).
Written Exam	Computer-based exam covering physics, radiation biology, pathology, anatomy, CBCT interpretation, and clinical radiology. Pass rate ~70–80%.
Oral Exam	Case-based oral examination with ABOMR examiners. Typically held annually.
Certification	Valid for 10 years; requires Continuing Certification maintenance.
After Certification	Eligible to advertise as a Diplomate ABOMR. Required for specialty practice in states that regulate specialty advertising (WA, NC, others).

F.5 Career Paths After US OMF Radiology Certification

Career Path	Setting	Typical Income (US)	Requirements
Dental School Faculty	Academic	\$110,000–\$180,000	ABOMR helpful; CODA program completion
Teleradiology / Remote CBCT Reporting	Private/Remote	\$150,000–\$300,000+	ABOMR strongly preferred; state dental license
Hospital Oral Surgery Dept Consultant	Hospital	\$130,000–\$200,000	Hospital credentialing; ABOMR preferred
VA / Federal Service (OMF Rad)	Federal	\$130,000–\$220,000	Green Card; federal credentialing; INBDE
Private OMF Rad Practice / Imaging Center	Private	\$140,000–\$250,000	State dental license; ABOMR; CBCT equipment
CBCT Interpretation Service (own business)	Entrepreneurial	\$180,000–\$400,000+	State license; ABOMR; business setup
Research / NIH / University	Academic	\$100,000–\$160,000	Research background; publications; PhD optional

■ *CBCT teleradiology is the most rapidly growing area of OMF Radiology in the US. Multiple companies (e.g., Dental Imaging Technologies, ProScan, private services) hire ABOMR Diplomates for remote interpretation. This can supplement income significantly during any training program.*

SECTION G – STATE MASTER REFERENCE TABLE (All 50 States + DC)

This master table consolidates all pathways for each US jurisdiction. '★' = particularly favorable for your profile. Board website URLs are provided for direct contact.

State	Board Website	AS Program in State?	GPR/PGY -1 Required?	Credentials/Endors. from Canada?	Faculty License?	OMF Rad Program?	Best Route for You
AL	dentalboard.alabama.gov	No	No	Unclear	Yes (UAB)	Possible	AS program elsewhere + AL endorsement
AK	commerce.alaska.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + AK endorsement
AZ	azda.gov	YES (Midwestern, A.T. Still)	No	Unclear	Yes	Possible	AS at Midwestern AZ (domestic rate possible)
AR	asbde.org	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + AR endorsement
CA ■	dental.ca.gov	YES (USC, UCSF, UCLA, etc.)	No (but CA complex)	NO	Yes (many schools)	YES (Loma Linda, UCSF)	AS at CA school preferred; or AS elsewhere + WREB + CA app
CO	dora.colorado.gov/dental	YES (U of Colorado)	No	Unclear	Yes	No	AS at U Colorado (domestic rate for GC)
CT	ct.gov/dph/dental	No (UConn nearby)	No	Unclear	Yes (UConn)	No	INBDE only state – watch for FTD developments
DE	dpr.delaware.gov/boards/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + DE endorsement
FL	floridasdentistry.gov	YES (UF, Nova SE, etc.)	No	Unclear	Yes (several)	YES (UF)	AS at UF (domestic rate GC) or credentials
GA	sos.ga.gov/dental	YES (MCG/AU)	No	Unclear	Yes	No	AS at GA + GA licensure
HI	cca.hawaii.gov/pvl/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WREB + HI endorsement
ID	ibol.idaho.gov/den	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WREB + ID endorsement
IL	idfpr.illinois.gov/dental	YES (UIC, Midwestern IL)	No	Unclear	Yes (UIC, Midwestern)	YES (UIC) ★	UIC AS (public, domestic rate) + faculty opportunity in OMF Rad
IN	in.gov/pla/dental	YES (Indiana U)	No	Unclear	Yes (IU)	YES (IU) ★	IU AS (public, domestic rate) + IU faculty/OMF Rad dept
IA	dentalboard.iowa.gov	YES (U of Iowa)	No	Unclear	Yes (U Iowa)	YES (U Iowa) ★	U Iowa AS + OMF Rad residency potential; low cost
KS	ksbde.org	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + KS endorsement
KY	dentistry.ky.gov	No	No	Unclear	Yes (U of L, UK)	No	AS elsewhere + KY endorsement
LA	lsbd.la.gov	YES (LSU)	No	Unclear	Yes (LSU)	No	LSU AS (cheapest public ~\$33K/yr domestic rate)
ME ★★	maine.gov/dental	No	No	YES – foreign/Canadian jurisdictions	No dental school	No	CREDENTIALS ROUTE: Active Canadian prov. license + NDEB + 5 yrs practice → possible ME licensure in months

State	Board Website	AS Program in State?	GPR/PGY -1 Required?	Credentials/Endors. from Canada?	Faculty License?	OMF Rad Program?	Best Route for You
MD	dhmh.maryland.gov/dental	YES (U Maryland)	No	Unclear	Yes (UMD)	YES (UMD) ★	UMD AS + OMF Rad dept at UMD
MA	mass.gov/dental	YES (BU, Tufts)	No	Unclear	Yes (BU, Tufts, Harvard)	YES (BU) ★	BU or Tufts AS + strong Boston academic market
MI	lara.michigan.gov/dental	YES (U Detroit Mercy)	No	Unclear	Yes (UM, UDM, WSU)	YES (UM) ★	UM has prestigious OMF Rad; UDM AS program
MN ★★	mn.gov/boards/dentistry	YES (U Minnesota)	No	YES – CANADIAN PROV. LICENSE ACCEPTED	Yes (UMN)	YES (UMN) ★	BEST ROUTE: Credentials from Canadian prov. license OR UMN AS (domestic rate) OR 1-yr AEGD/GPR → MN license. Multiple routes.
MS	msbde.ms.gov	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + MS endorsement
MO	pr.mo.gov/dental	No (UMKC)	No	Unclear	Yes (UMKC)	No	UMKC AS + MO licensure
MT	boards.bsd.dli.mt.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WREB/ADEX + MT endorsement; rural incentives
NE	dhhs.ne.gov/dental	No (Creighton private)	No	Unclear	Yes (Creighton)	No	AS elsewhere + NE endorsement
NV	nvdental.nv.gov	YES (UNLV, Roseman)	No	Unclear	Yes (UNLV, Roseman)	No	UNLV AS (public, domestic rate) or Roseman 18 mo accelerated
NH	oplc.nh.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + NH endorsement; small market
NJ	njconsumeraffairs.gov/dental	YES (Rutgers)	No	Unclear	Yes (Rutgers)	YES (Rutgers) ★	Rutgers AS (public, domestic rate); NY metro
NM	nmbde.org	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WREB + NM endorsement; shortage areas
NY ★	op.nysed.gov/dental	YES (NYU, Columbia, etc.)	YES – PGY-1 mandatory ALL dentists	Unclear direct	Yes (NYU, Columbia, Buffalo)	YES (NYU, Columbia, Buffalo) ★	PGY-1 (GPR) in NY hospital system → NY license. Great stipend. Massive NYC market. OMF Rad programs at NYU/Columbia.
NC	ncdentalboard.org	YES (UNC, ECU)	No	Unclear	Yes (UNC, ECU)	YES (UNC) ★	UNC AS (cheapest public \$36K/yr domestic rate); strong OMF Rad dept at UNC
ND	nddentalboard.org	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + ND endorsement; very small market
OH	dental.ohio.gov	YES (OSU, CWRU)	No	Unclear	Yes (OSU, CWRU)	YES (OSU) ★	OSU AS (public, domestic rate); strong OMF Rad at OSU
OK	dentistry.ok.gov	No (OU)	No	Unclear	Yes (OU)	No	AS elsewhere + OK endorsement; OU for faculty
OR	oregon.gov/dental	No (OHSU)	No	Unclear	Yes (OHSU)	No	AS elsewhere + WREB + OR endorsement; OHSU for faculty
PA	dos.pa.gov/dental	YES (Temple, Pitt)	No	Unclear	Yes (Temple, Pitt, Penn)	YES (Penn, Temple) ★	Temple or Pitt AS; Penn Ivy League for OMF Rad faculty
RI	health.ri.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + RI endorsement; small market
SC	scdhec.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + SC endorsement

State	Board Website	AS Program in State?	GPR/PGY -1 Required?	Credentials/Endors. from Canada?	Faculty License?	OMF Rad Program?	Best Route for You
SD	dlr.sd.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + SD endorsement; shortage areas
TN	tn.gov/dental	YES (UTK, Meharry)	No	Unclear	Yes	No	UTK AS (~\$34K/yr domestic rate); growing Nashville/Memphis market
TX ★	tsbde.texas.gov	YES (Texas A&M, UT Houston)	No	Unclear	Yes (several)	YES (UT Houston, Baylor) ★	Massive market. Two public AS programs (domestic rate). OMF Rad at UT Houston.
UT	dopl.utah.gov/dental	YES (Roseman)	No	Unclear	Yes (Roseman)	No	Roseman 18-month accelerated AS; SLC growing market
VT	sos.vermont.gov/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + VT endorsement; very small market
VA	dhp.virginia.gov/dental	No (VCU)	No	Unclear	Yes (VCU)	YES (VCU) ★	VCU AS + OMF Rad at VCU; DC metro market
WA ★	doh.wa.gov/dental	YES (U Washington)	No but special GPR/AEGD route	Unclear direct	Yes (UW)	YES (UW) ★	UW AS (domestic rate) OR 1-yr CODA GPR/AEGD in WA underserved community → WA license. OMF Rad program at UW.
WV	wvdentalboard.org	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WV endorsement; rural shortage areas
WI	dsps.wi.gov/dental	No (Marquette private)	No	Unclear	Yes (Marquette, UW-Madison)	No	Marquette AS + WI licensure; Milwaukee market
WY	plboards.state.wy.us/dental	No	No	Unclear	No dental school	No	AS elsewhere + WREB/ADEX + WY endorsement; shortage areas; very small market
DC	dchealth.dc.gov/dental	YES (Howard)	No	Unclear	Yes (Howard)	NO	Howard AS + DC licensure; federal proximity; small jurisdiction

■ ★★★ = Minnesota: Best overall credentials route for your profile. ★★ = Maine: Possible fastest credentials route. ★ = Particularly favorable state for one or more pathways.

SECTION H – COST COMPARISON & TIMELINE OVERVIEW

Pathway	Min Time to US License	Max Time	Estimated Total Cost (Low)	Estimated Total Cost (High)	Practice Scope After
P1: AS DDS/DMD (public school, GC domestic rate)	21 months	30 months	\$108,000	\$140,000	Unrestricted – all states via endorsement
P1: AS DDS/DMD (private school)	21 months	30 months	\$198,000	\$282,000	Unrestricted – all states via endorsement
P2: NY PGY-1 (GPR) → NY License	12–14 months	18 months	\$2,000–\$5,000 (paid stipend ~\$50K)	\$10,000	NY state (then endorsement elsewhere ~\$500/state)
P2: WA CODA GPR → WA License	12–14 months	18 months	\$2,000–\$5,000 (paid stipend)	\$10,000	WA state (then endorsement elsewhere)
P2: MN AEGD/GPR → MN License	12–14 months	18 months	\$2,000–\$5,000 (paid stipend)	\$10,000	MN state (then endorsement elsewhere)
P3: Credentials (MN from Canadian prov.)	3–6 months	12 months	\$500–\$2,000	\$3,000	MN state (then endorsement elsewhere ~\$500/state)
P3: Credentials (ME from Canadian prov.)	3–9 months	15 months	\$500–\$2,000	\$3,000	ME state (then endorsement elsewhere)
P4: Faculty License (dental school)	4–8 weeks	3 months	\$200–\$500	\$1,000	Dental school premises only (not private practice)
P4: VA Federal Employment	4–12 weeks	6 months	\$0 (federal employer covers)	\$0	VA/federal facilities only; no state license needed
P5: US OMF Rad Residency + ABOMR	24 months	36 months	\$10,000 (with stipend)	\$40,000	Specialty practice (OMF Rad) + general dental license needed for private practice
P5: OMF Rad Residency + MN Credentials (parallel)	24–30 months	36 months	\$12,000–\$30,000	\$50,000	Full general + OMF Rad specialty – maximum scope

H.2 Exam Fees Summary

Exam / Assessment	Cost	When Needed
INBDE (Integrated National Board Dental Exam)	~\$575 per day (2 days = ~\$1,150)	Required by most AS programs and many state boards
ADEX/CDCA Clinical Exam	\$1,200–\$2,000	After DDS/DMD graduation; most eastern/central states
WREB/CRDTS Clinical Exam	\$1,200–\$1,800	After DDS/DMD graduation; western states
SRTA Clinical Exam	\$800–\$1,200	TX and some southern states
State Dental Jurisprudence Exam	\$50–\$200 per state	Required by virtually all states; usually online
ABOMR Application + Exam	\$1,500–\$3,000 total	OMF Radiology board certification
State License Application	\$200–\$1,000 per state	Per state, initial application
State License Renewal (biennial)	\$100–\$500 per state	Every 1–2 years per state
CAAPID Application	\$300–\$600	AS program application (covers multiple programs)
Credential Evaluation (ECE/NACES)	\$300–\$400	Once; for AS program admission

SECTION I – STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS & ACTION PLAN

I.1 Recommended Strategy: The Three-Track Parallel Approach

Given your unique profile, the optimal strategy is NOT to choose a single pathway sequentially, but to pursue three parallel tracks simultaneously, each supporting the others:

TRACK A – IMMEDIATE INCOME (Start now, 4–12 weeks)

- Apply for VA federal employment via USAJobs.gov as a dentist or OMF radiologist.
- VA does not require a state license; your Green Card qualifies you.
- Expected salary: \$120,000–\$220,000 depending on location and grade.
- This provides income while pursuing Tracks B and C simultaneously.
- VA experience also strengthens your credentials route applications.

TRACK B – FASTEST STATE LICENSE (Start now, 3–12 months)

- Obtain Canadian provincial license immediately if not already held (NDEB → RCDSO/CDAS/CDSBC; 4–8 weeks).
- Contact Minnesota Board of Dentistry and Maine Board of Dental Examiners in writing. Request written confirmation of credentials-route eligibility based on NDEB + Canadian prov. license.
- If MN confirms eligibility: apply for MN licensure by credentials. Timeline: 3–6 months.
- MN license → immediately apply for endorsement to any other state you want to practice in.
- Parallel: begin INBDE study and testing (if required by MN/ME board for your route).

TRACK C – LONG-TERM MAXIMUM MOBILITY (Start in 6–12 months, complete in 2–3 years)

- Apply to CODA-accredited OMF Radiology residency programs via ADEA PASS (ideally at UMN, UW, IU, or Iowa).
- If OMF Rad residency does not work out or you prefer general dentistry scope: apply to advanced standing DDS/DMD at a public school (UMN, UNC, LSU, UT Houston, Texas A&M;) where domestic tuition applies.
- Upon completion: US DDS/DMD + ABOMR certification = full unrestricted practice in any specialty and/or general dentistry in any US state.
- Endorsement to all desired states (\$300–\$800 per state).

I.2 Month-by-Month Action Timeline

	Action Items
Month 1–2	• Apply for Canadian provincial license (NDEB → province) • Create USAJobs.gov profile and apply for VA dentist/OMF Rad positions • Contact MN Board of Dentistry and ME Board in writing re: credentials route • Register for INBDE (schedule within 3 months) • Request credential evaluation from ECE (if considering AS programs)
Month 2–4	• Canadian provincial license received • Submit MN and/or ME credentials application if boards confirm eligibility • Take INBDE Part 1 and Part 2 (or full integrated INBDE) • Begin VA employment (federal; no state license needed) • Research ADEA PASS application for OMF Rad residencies (cycle opens ~April)

Month 4–8	• MN/ME credentials license decisions expected • If MN licensed: apply for endorsement to 2–3 additional target states • Apply via ADEA PASS for OMF Rad residency programs (July positions) • If pursuing AS DDS/DMD: apply via ADEA CAAPID (cycle April–Sept) • Explore NY PGY-1 programs (apply independently to hospitals)
Month 8–18	• Begin GPR/AEGD, OMF Rad residency, or AS program • Continue VA employment if applicable • Maintain Canadian provincial license in good standing • Network with dental school faculty in target region
Month 18–36	• Complete residency or AS program • Take state clinical board exam (ADEX/WREB) if required • Apply for state license in graduation state • Take ABOMR exam if OMF Rad residency completed • Apply for endorsement to all desired states • Explore CBCT teleradiology business opportunities
Year 3+	• Unrestricted practice in multiple states • ABOMR Diplomate status • Consider additional state licenses via endorsement (\$300–\$800 each) • Explore academic appointment if desired • CBCT teleradiology private service as income supplement

I.3 Key Contacts & Resources

Organization / Resource	URL / Contact	Purpose
Minnesota Board of Dentistry	mn.gov/boards/dentistry (612) 617-2250	Credentials route inquiry – your #1 priority call
Maine Board of Dental Examiners	maine.gov/dental (207) 287-3333	Credentials route inquiry – foreign jurisdiction provision
ADEA CAAPID (AS programs)	adea.org/caapid	Advanced standing DDS/DMD application portal
ADEA PASS (Specialty/GPR)	adea.org/pass	GPR, AEGD, and specialty residency application
VA USAJobs.gov	usajobs.gov – search 'dentist' + 'VA'	Federal dental employment; no state license required
ABOMR	abomr.com	American Board of OMF Radiology; board certification
CODA (program accreditation)	ada.org/coda	Verify accreditation status of any program
ADA State Dental Boards	ada.org/stateboard	Links to all 50 state + DC dental boards
ECE (Credential Evaluation)	ece.org	Foreign credential evaluation for AS program admission
INBDE Exam	ada.org/inbde	National Board Dental Exam registration and info
Prometric (testing centers)	prometric.com	Schedule INBDE and other standardized exams
NDEB Canada	ndeb.ca	Your existing certification body; verify standing
CDAS Alberta	dentalregulatory.ca	Alberta provincial dental license (NDEB recognized)
RCDSO Ontario	rcdso.org	Ontario provincial dental license (NDEB recognized)
CDSBC British Columbia	cdsbc.org	BC provincial dental license (NDEB recognized)

I.4 Final Summary: Your Highest-Priority Actions

Priority 1 – CALL MN BOARD TODAY

Call or email Minnesota Board of Dentistry. Ask: 'I hold an NDEB certificate and a Canadian provincial dental license. Can I apply for MN licensure by credentials under your Canadian province provision?' This could give you a US license in 3–6 months.

Priority 2 – CALL ME BOARD THIS WEEK	Contact Maine Board of Dental Examiners. Ask about their 'foreign administrative divisions' credentials provision and whether your NDEB + Canadian provincial license qualifies.
Priority 3 – VA EMPLOYMENT APPLICATION	Apply immediately to VA positions at USAJobs.gov. As a Green Card holder with OMF Radiology specialty, you are a highly competitive candidate for federal dental positions that pay \$120,000–\$220,000 and do not require a state dental license.
Priority 4 – CANADIAN PROVINCIAL LICENSE	If you do not yet have an active Canadian provincial license, apply to your nearest provincial body this week (NDEB → provincial; 4–8 weeks; ~\$300–\$500). This is the prerequisite for the MN and ME credentials routes.
Priority 5 – INBDE REGISTRATION	Register for the INBDE at ada.org/inbde . This exam will be required by most pathways (AS programs, GPR/AEGD programs, and some state boards). Schedule it within the next 3–4 months. Cost ~\$1,150 total.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER: This guide was prepared based on information available as of early 2026. State dental board requirements, regulations, and policies change frequently. All information should be independently verified directly with the relevant state dental board and/or a US-licensed attorney specializing in professional licensing before making any decisions. This document does not constitute legal or professional licensing advice. The author/preparer makes no representations as to the accuracy, completeness, or current validity of any information herein.